

Entrepreneurship as a Black Woman

Launching your project, despite the extra obstacles

4 psychology approaches · tips & resources — by EvaTalk

CONTENTS

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1. Before you begin
2. The 4 approaches
3. Psychodynamic lens
4. CBT lens
5. Humanistic lens
6. Systemic lens
7. Tips & advice
8. Your workbook
9. Your 4-week plan

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Launching your project, despite the extra obstacles

Entrepreneurship is already a challenge; doing it as a Black woman often means facing extra obstacles: harder access to funding, legitimacy endlessly to prove, a lack of role models and networks. Your project is legitimate, and these obstacles say nothing about your worth.

This guide helps you move past the doubt, lean on your uniqueness as a strength, and move forward despite the obstacles — surrounded by support.

Your intention

Your project (or idea) and the obstacle that holds you back most: _____

The 4 approaches

This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

Psychodynamic — understand the root.

CBT — ease the negative thoughts.

Humanistic — reconcile with yourself.

Systemic — act on your environment.

Legitimacy & impostor feelings

Doubt about your legitimacy is reinforced by the lack of role models who look like you in entrepreneurship — it can feel like not 'belonging'.

This doubt comes from the context, not a lack of ability in you.

Example

Seeing 'no one like her' leading companies, Aïcha doubted her place. Understanding the doubt's origin freed her.

My legitimacy doubt

What makes you doubt you 'belong' as an entrepreneur? Where does it come from?

Ability vs context

Separate: what's a real skill to build / what's a doubt imported from the context.

→ *My doubt comes from the context — not a lack of ability.*

The thoughts that hold you back

'It's not for me', 'I won't make it', 'no one will fund me': these thoughts, sometimes fed by real obstacles, make you give up before trying.

Softening them (without denying the obstacles) gets you moving.

Example

Sure 'no one would ever fund her', Nia still applied to a dedicated program — and was selected.

Blockers journal

Note: the blocking thought · what's a real obstacle (to get around) / what's amplified fear.

One step anyway

What small step can you take this week, despite the doubt (a call, a funding search)?

→ *I tell real obstacles from fear — and move forward anyway.*

Your project, your legitimacy

Your vision, your experience, your uniqueness are strengths — and often a real business asset (you see needs others miss). You belong in entrepreneurship.

What makes you different is also what makes your project valuable.

Example

By owning that her experience was her strength, Léa built an offer no one else had — and found her market.

My uniqueness, my strength

Write: what your path/experience brings that's unique to your project.

The need I see

What need (others may miss) does your project fill?

→ *My uniqueness is a strength — and an asset for my project.*

Moving forward despite the extra obstacles

Concretely: seek funding and programs (including those dedicated to women, minorities or entrepreneurship), join networks of Black women entrepreneurs, find a mentor, validate your idea step by step, and build support.

Getting informed and surrounded turns obstacles into crossable steps.

Example

By joining a network of Black women entrepreneurs, Sofia found role models, advice and a funding lead she didn't know about.

My supports

Note: 1 network of entrepreneurs · 1 funding lead/program · 1 potential mentor.

Validate step by step

What small test (customers, MVP) to validate your idea before betting it all?

→ *Getting informed and surrounded makes obstacles crossable.*

Practical tips & advice

Tips & advice

- Your project is legitimate; the structural obstacles (funding, bias) are real and don't judge your worth.
- Start small and validate your idea (customers, MVP) before betting it all.
- Seek funding and programs — some dedicated to women/minorities/entrepreneurship.
- Join networks of Black women entrepreneurs (role models, advice, funding).
- Find a mentor and document your wins.
- This guide is support, not financial or legal advice — surround yourself with pros for those aspects.

To fill in

My supports

Network / funding / mentor	Next action

Validate my idea

My small test	What I want to check

Your 4-week plan

Week 1 — Understand where my legitimacy doubt comes from.

Week 2 — Tell real obstacles from amplified fear.

Week 3 — Lean on my uniqueness as a strength.

Week 4 — Get informed, surrounded, validate step by step.

Your plan in 3 lines

- My uniqueness that serves my project:
- The need my project fills:
- My first support (network/funding/mentor):

TO CLOSE

Your project is legitimate — launch it, surrounded, despite the extra obstacles.

Your project is legitimate — launch it, surrounded.

The extra obstacles you face as a Black woman entrepreneur are real: this guide doesn't minimize them. It's a coaching and psychoeducation tool — not financial or legal advice, nor a guarantee of results. If you're going through a hard time, reach out to a crisis line in your country. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.